



TRISEC

TRITON MARITIME SECURITY

Voyage Risk Assessment

MT Lima 9

Barcelona, Venezuela to Dos Bocas, Mexico

Voyage Overview



Dos Bocas, Mexico

Puerto José, Venezuela

Vessel and Cargo Overview

Lima 9

- Aframax
- Dead Weight Tonnage: 105,000
- Speed: 13 knots
- Freeboard: 3.5 meters above water
- Carrying: 600,000 barrels of unrefined Venezuelan crude oil



Sailing to Venezuela / At Port in Barcelona (Puerto José)

Sailing to Venezuela from the Atlantic Ocean

- No current major security threats

At Port in Barcelona (Puerto José) and Venezuelan territorial waters

- The US operation *Southern Spear* is blockading vessels
 - Several vessels have been seized by the US
 - Close compliance with US regulations is vital
- Corruption
- Venezuelan piracy
 - Activities have currently decreased from its peak

The likelihood of these risks is unlikely, yet the potential impact is major.

		Impact				
		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
Likelihood	Very Likely					
	Likely					
	Roughly even chance					
	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



US President Trump orders total blockade of sanctioned oil tankers entering or leaving Venezuela



Piracy in Latin America 2015-2025

August 2025 | Source: Information compiled by InSight Crime

Piracy in the region is concentrated in vulnerable coast and river regions, and intensifies in times of political, economic, and social crisis.



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Sanctions Risk

OFAC (Office of Foreign Assets Control)

- **E.O. 14373** — established "Foreign Government Deposit Funds" into which payments to the Venezuelan government or PDVSA must be made
- **GL 46B** — the master licence for Venezuelan oil trade. Authorises "established US entities" to lift, export, reexport, sell, resell, supply, store, market, purchase, deliver, and transport Venezuelan-origin oil, including chartering vessels and obtaining marine insurance
- **GL 50A** — authorises six named major energy companies (BP, Chevron, Eni, Repsol, Shell, Maurel & Prom) and their subsidiaries to engage in oil and gas operations

The likelihood of these risks is unlikely, yet the potential impact is major.

		Impact				
		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
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	Likely					
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	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



Narcotics Risk

Placement

- Attached to hull by underwater divers
- Brought on board by corrupt port workers/officials

Implications

- Vessel detention or forfeiture
- Fines
- Reputational and commercial damage

The likelihood of these risks is roughly even, yet the potential impact is major.

		Impact				
		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
Likelihood	Very Likely					
	Likely					
	Roughly even chance					
	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



Bay of Campeche / Puerto Dos Bocas

Arriving in port and offshore anchoring

Armed robbery against ships

- Organized crime groups; Jalisco New Generation Cartel
- Armed robberies with guns
 - Bunker fuel theft
 - Onboard equipment
- While the vessel is berthing at an oil terminal or anchored offshore
- Socioeconomic conditions and cartel territorial expansion
- Crude tankers are slow ships, the vessel will be laden, & the vessel remains stationary for extended periods of time

Armed robbery against ships is considered unlikely, with a moderate impact.

		Impact				
		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
Likelihood	Very Likely					
	Likely					
	Roughly even chance					
	Unlikely					
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Risk Mitigation – Venezuelan Waters/ Puerto José

Mitigating risks – Port of Barcelona (Puerto José) and Venezuelan waters

- Crew training is crucial
 - Responding to a variety of situations
 - Maintaining up-to-date security practices
 - Ensuring effective communications onboard and with officials
- Physical improvements
- Monitoring closely the evolving situation
 - Changes in the US regulations

The likelihood of the risks can be reduced through effective mitigation measures.

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		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
Likelihood	Very Likely					
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	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



Risk Mitigation – Sanctions and Narcotics

Sanctions

- Keep documents on bridge
- Do not turn off AIS

Narcotics

- Restrict gangway access rigorously at Puerto José
- Conduct an internal search before departure (void spaces, engine room, manholes etc)
- Commission a hull check
- Crew briefing
- Do not physically resist boarding
- Contact the shipowner immediately

The likelihood of these risks can be reduced to very unlikely through effective mitigation measures.

		Impact				
		Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
Likelihood	Very Likely					
	Likely					
	Roughly even chance					
	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



Risk Mitigation – Bay of Campeche / Puerto Dos Bocas

Mitigating risks – Bay of Campeche / Port of Dos Bocas

- Awareness and crew preparation
- Surveillance, especially at night
- Fortify the ship: razor wire & hoses
- Citadel is prepared with adequate water & oxygen

Armed robbery against ships can be considered very unlikely when effective mitigation measures are implemented.

		Impact				
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	Likely					
	Roughly even chance					
	Unlikely					
	Very Unlikely					



Conclusion

📍 Port in Barcelona, Puerto José, Venezuela
Risk assessment with mitigation: very unlikely, with major impact

📍 Port of Dos Bocas, Mexico
Risk assessment with mitigation: very unlikely, with moderate impact

📍 Open waters
Risk assessment with mitigation: very unlikely, with major impact

Final assessment of risks:

With mitigation, the overall risk assessment of the Lima 9's route is very unlikely, but risks hold a major impact.

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